

FIRSTENERGY AKRON MARATHON, HALF MARATHON, & TEAM RELAY

September 25-26, 2026

FINAL INSTRUCTIONS

TAKE A LOOK INSIDE

Page 2: Health & Fitness Expo
Page 3: Kids Fun Run
Page 4: Start Line
Page 5: Course
Page 6: Spectators & Accessibility
Page 7: Finish Line
Page 8: FirstEnergy Finisher Festival
Page 9: Team Relay
Pages 10-15: Maps & Road Closures
Pages 16 & 17: Directions & Parking



FirstEnergy

MARATHON
HALF | RELAY

RACE WEEKEND AT A GLANCE

FRIDAY

Health & Fitness Expo:
John S. Knight Center
77 E. Mill St, Akron
Packet Pickup, Official Merchandise
Store presented by Fleet Feet, Expo
Vendors, and more.
11:00 a.m. - Doors Open
8:00 p.m. - Doors Close

The Mandel Family Kids Fun Run
presented by Akron Children's:
Start: Akron Children's Hospital
214 W. Bowery St, Akron
Finish: Lock 3
200 S. Main St, Akron
5:00 p.m. - Bib Pickup Opens
6:00 p.m. - Race Start
6:45 p.m. - Course Closes
7:30 p.m. - Venue Closes

SATURDAY

FirstEnergy Akron Marathon, Half
Marathon, & Team Relay:
Start: Akron Art Museum
1 S. High St, Akron
Finish: Lock 3
200 S. Main St, Akron
6:00 a.m. - Opening Ceremony
6:58 a.m. - Wheelchair Division & Push
Team Start
7:00 a.m. - Marathon, Half Marathon &
Team Relay Start
1:45 p.m. - Course Closes
2:00 p.m. - FirstEnergy Finisher Festival
Closes



HEALTH & FITNESS EXPO

You will receive an email/text message race week with your bib number. Please know your bib number prior to arriving.

All participants MUST pick up their packets on Friday, September 25, 2026. Participant shirts are located at the end of the Expo Hall. Each participant should pick up their own packet. There is NO packet pick up the day of the race. If you are unable to attend, race packets may be picked up by a friend or family member who must verify the participant's registration information.

Bib Information

Make sure to pin your bib on the front of your shirt with the provided safety pins. This is crucial for accurate timing and the best race photos. And remember: take care of your bib! Any creases or cuts could ruin your timing device.

Your race number is linked to your registration data, so it MUST be yours. Participating under someone else's number could create serious consequences for participants and organizers alike. Correct information allows medical staff to identify and treat participants if necessary, and it also helps ensure accuracy in race results and awards.

Location: John S. Knight Center
77 E. Mill St, Akron, OH 44308

Date: Friday, September 25
Time: 11:00 a.m. to 8:00 p.m.

Explore the Health & Fitness Expo:

While you pick up your bib and participant shirt, explore the various features at the Expo, including:

- Purchase Akron Marathon merchandise at the Official Store presented by Fleet Feet.
- Look and feel your best! Explore the Ready, Set, PR Zone. This area has complimentary experiences like hair braiding, custom shoe charms, glitter freckles, and inspirational temporary tattoos.
- Swing through the Runners' Lounge with NormaTec boots, massages, and the spectator sign-making station.
- Donate gently used sneakers.

NEW for 2026: Half & Full marathon participants will receive socks with their participant shirt.



The Mandel Family Kids Fun Run

presented by Akron Children's

Date: Friday, September 25
Start: Akron Children's Hospital
214 W. Bowery St, Akron
Finish: Lock 3
200 S. Main St, Akron



Kids Fun Run Schedule

- 5:00 p.m. On-site registration and Bib Pickup opens
- 6:00 p.m. Race Start, post-race activities begin
- 7:30 p.m. Post-race activities close
- 8:00 p.m. Akron Children's Museum closes



FREE fun run for children 12 years of age and under. Participants have the opportunity to run this under one mile course and finish at the same finish line of Saturday's event. All participants receive a giveaway, goodie bag, medal, & healthy snack. After the run, enjoy kid friendly music at the Lock 3 stage, interact with community partners at the finisher festival, and participate in games and activities.

View the course map on Page 14



For additional Kids Fun Run information visit the Akron Marathon website.

START

Start Line Corrals

Participants should begin loading into their respective corral 30 minutes before race start. Corrals will close 15 minutes before race start. There will be wave and pace signs which indicate where to line up inside the corral.

High Street will be closed from Mill to Market to all participants and spectators until 6:50 a.m. Participants should take Main Street to Market to access corral entrances. There are corral access points on Market. Only participants with a bib will be allowed pass those access points.

Each participants' time begins when they pass over the Start Line timing mats. Wave placement will not affect the final race time or place in the race (except for overall winners which is based on gun time).

The timing mats are removed shortly after the final participant in wave 7 crosses the starting line. If you are not at the start line at this time, you will not have an official race time.

Wave Start

The race will start in 7 waves. Each wave will walk up to the Start Line and have their own starting commands.

Each participant will have a designated wave based on pace submitted during registration. Your wave number will be indicated on your race bib.

	WAVE	PACE
Blue Corral	Elite	Assigned
	Seeded	Assigned
	Wave 1	5:00 - 7:59
Yellow Corral	Wave 2	8:00 - 8:59
Red Corral	Wave 3	9:00 - 9:29
	Wave 4	9:30 - 9:59
Orange Corral	Wave 5	10:00 - 10:59
	Wave 6	11:00 - 11:59
	Wave 7	12:00 - plus

Location: 1 S. High St, Akron

6:00 a.m. - Opening Ceremony

6:45 a.m. - Corrals Close

6:58 a.m. - Wheelchair Division & Push Team Start

7:00 a.m. - Marathon, Half Marathon & Team Relay Start

Medical

For any medical needs, Summa Health will be near the Information Booth, located at the John S. Knight Center Plaza.

Restrooms

Restrooms will be located in the Akron Public Schools parking lot off W Market St, on E Market across from the Akron Art Museum, and inside the corrals on High St at the back of the yellow and orange corrals.

Parking

Free parking, at designated city decks and lots, is available throughout downtown on race day. See pages 16 and 17 for recommendations and map.

Spectators

The starting corrals are for participants only! We ask that all spectators view the start near Mill St south of the Start Line. This will reduce congestion and allow ample space for participants and spectators alike. For spectator viewing information, see page 6.

Prohibited Items

For the safety of our participants, the Akron Marathon does not permit: pets, skateboards, scooters, strollers, bicycles, roller blades, baby carriers, or any other types of vehicles (other than official Marathon vehicles and bicycles) on the course. The Akron Marathon reserves the right to disqualify and remove anyone from the course who has any of the above items or does not act in a safe manner.

Non-registered participants are not permitted to run or walk within the boundaries of the official marathon course. Non-registered participants pacing a registered participant goes against USATF rules and could result in disqualification. It is important that family, friends, and teammates NEVER cross the Finish Line or enter the finish zone which begins approximately 2/10 mile before the finish. Course monitors and police will be stationed throughout the course; ensuring only registered participants are on the course.

Information Booths will be located at the Health & Fitness Expo, Start Line, and Finish Line to help with any race related questions or concerns.

COURSE

Course

The 2026 course features a dynamic downtown start, a new out and back section on South Main Street, and the high-energy Finisher Festival at Lock 3. Course highlights include: Firestone Park, The University of Akron Campus, North Hill, Towpath Trail, Sand Run, West Akron block parties, Stan Hywet and Highland Square. See pages 10 & 11 for the maps.

Provisions

Restrooms: Portable restrooms will be available throughout the course, including the Start and Finish Lines, fluid stations, Relay Exchange Zones, and Shuttle Loading Area. Of those restrooms, half will be designated for women and equipped with tampons.

Fluids: As you approach a fluid station, lemon lime Gatorade will be available first followed by water. It is recommended to carry your own fluid. There will be an area to refill bottles and self carry options at the end of each fluid station. Volunteers will assist in refilling. We do not recommend taking food or fluids from non-official locations.

Energy: Salted Caramel (w/caffeine) & Raspberry Lemonade (no caffeine) GU Energy Gel and Blueberry Pomegranate (no caffeine) GU Energy Chews will be provided at 3 locations along the Marathon course for full and half marathon participants only. In addition, pretzels & Nerds Gummy Clusters will be provided at the last 2 locations. Participants that require energy gel earlier or at different times should plan to be self-supported.

Stopain: There will be a Stopain station on the course located at Mile 21. Stopain is a topical pain relief gel for muscles and joints.

Medical: There will be 7 medical aid stations available to participants throughout the course, Start Line, and Finish Line. Summa Health will coordinate all medical assistance during this event.

There will be NON-MEDICAL aid shuttles to transport participants, who choose not to continue the race, from the aid tents back to the Finish.

NSAID's (Non-Steroidal Anti-inflammatory Drugs such as Advil, Aleve, Ibuprofen, etc.) are not recommended the few days before the race and will NOT be provided at aid tents. NSAIDs, especially in dehydrated participants, can adversely affect the kidneys and can increase the risk of hyponatremia (low blood sodium). Tylenol will be available.

Race Photos

Photos will be taken at the finish line. An email will be sent to participants the week following the race when photos are ready to be viewed. By attending this event, participants and spectators acknowledge that their photo, video, and/or audio may be captured and used at the discretion of the Akron Marathon Race Series.

Closure

Course Limit: The marathon course is officially open for six and a half hours after the last person crosses the Start Line; equivalent to approximately 15:00 minutes per mile pace. The half marathon route will remain open for 3.5 hours, equivalent to a 16:00 minutes per mile pace. Participants slower than this pace will be asked to move to the sidewalk or board the SAG - course closure vehicle. The Finish Line, medical aid stations and fluid stations will remain open for a six-and-a-half-hour pace and close on schedule.

Full marathon and relay teams need to be at the split at mile 12.5 by 10:20 a.m. to continue on to the full course.

Pace Team

Provided by On Pace, pacers will be available for many of the Boston Marathon qualifying times. Pacers will follow the Full Marathon route. Half Marathon runners can join the pace team up to the split at mile 12.5. Pace teams are led by experienced pacers who run a steady pace so the group can achieve their goal of finishing the marathon at a particular time. There is no cost to run with the pace group.



Signage

Located at each medical aid station, as well as each Relay Exchange Zone, there will be a color-coded flag system to update participants on the course alert level. Please see chart for details.

ALERT LEVEL	EVENT CONDITIONS	RECOMMENDED ACTIONS		
EXTREME	Extreme & Dangerous Event Cancelled	Participation stopped Follow event official instructions	M	MARATHON
HIGH	Potentially Dangerous	Slow down Observe course changes Follow official instruction Consider stopping	H	HALF MARATHON
MODERATE	Less than ideal	Slow down Be prepared for worsening conditions	R	TEAM RELAY
LOW	Good	Enjoy the event Be alert		

As you approach all Relay Exchange Zones and the split for the Half Marathon, you will see color coded signs that match your bib color. Please stay to the side of the road that corresponds to your bib color for a hassle-free transition through these critical points.

Course Split

The Half Marathon will follow the Full Marathon course until mile 12.5. When participants come off the Y-Bridge onto High St shortly after mile 12.4, the Half Marathon will shift to the left side of the road, Full Marathon and Relay participants will shift to the right side of the road. At Market St, the Half Marathon will turn left to separate from the Full Marathon course. The Full Marathon and Relay will turn right on Market St. Please pay attention to signs and volunteers at this location to make sure you stay on the appropriate course.

SPECTATORS & ACCESSIBILITY

2026 Spectator Map

1 Viewing Point #1 (Start Line)

Watch the start of the race south of the starting line near Mill St. Spectators are not allowed inside the start line corrals. High St. north of Mill St. will be closed until 6:50am.

2 Viewing Point #2 (Mile 8.7)

From the Start: ●●●●●

- Walk east one block on Mill St.
- View runners at mile 8.7 on Broadway.

3 Viewing Point #3 (Mile 12.6)

*Marathon & Relay only

From Broadway: ●●●●●

- Walk north on Broadway.
- Left on Market St. and walk 2 blocks.
- View runners on Market St. near Main St.

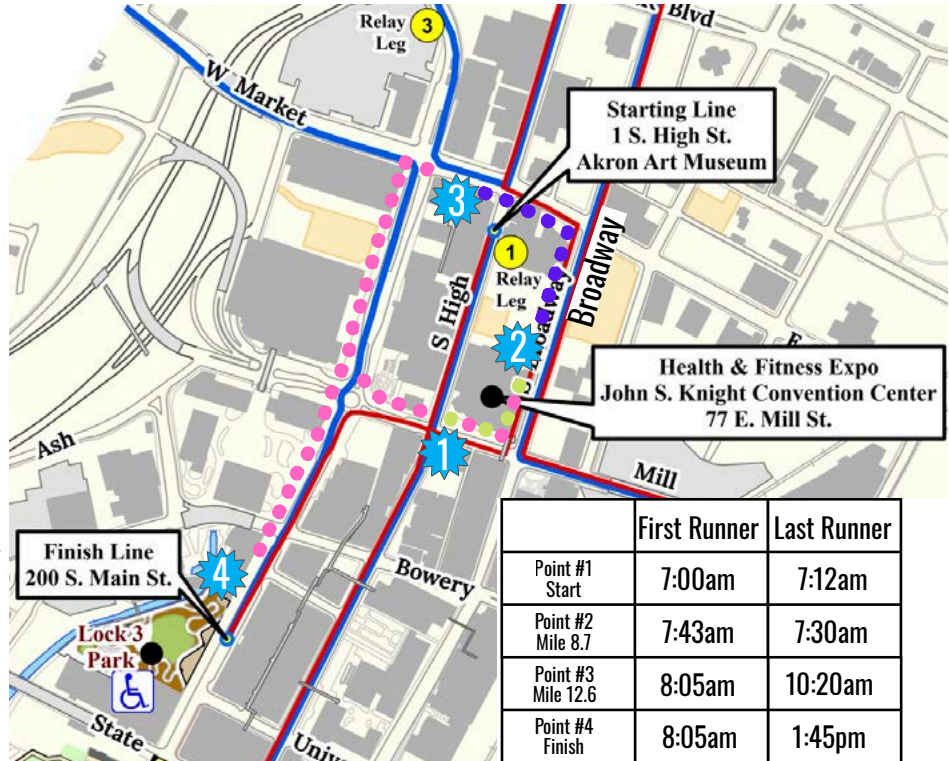
4 Viewing Point #4 (Finish Line)

From Broadway: ●●●●●

- Right on Mill St.
- Cross Main St. at Mill. Left on Main St. to reach the Finish Line / enter the Finisher Festival.

From Market St: ●●●●●

- Cross Main St. at Market St. Left on Main St. to reach the Finish Line / enter the Finisher Festival.



*Spectators: Please stay on sidewalks. Please be aware of participants as you cross the roads. Please note some roads remain open for traffic.

*Participants and spectators should choose a meeting location prior to the race, to meet up at after the race.

Accessibility Information

Guide Dogs & Service Animals

Pets are not permitted on the course or at the Finisher Festival, however, approved guide dogs and service animals are permitted.

KultureCity: Sensory Inclusion

The Akron Marathon has teamed up with KultureCity to help those who may need additional support in the race environment. Sensory bags will be available at the Information Booth located at the Health & Fitness Expo, Start Line, & Finish Line.

Restroom Accommodations

Portable restrooms with wheelchair accessibility are located near the front entrance of the Art Museum, in the Akron Public Schools parking lot, and on Market St at the Start Line. At the Finish Line they are located in the Finisher Festival and indoor restrooms are available inside of Lock 3.

Adult Changing Tables

Adult changing tables are available inside Lock 3 at the FirstEnergy Finisher Festival and at Akron Children's Hospital at the Start of the Kids Fun Run.

Parking Accommodations

Accessible parking for the finish line viewing area is available at the State Street Deck, 51 W. State St. For parking at the start line, accessible parking is available with a VIP pass by request.

Transportation

A UDS van with wheelchair accessibility will be located on the corner of Main St and Buchtel from 7am - 12pm for any race day needs.

Accessibility Accommodations

For volunteer or spectator accommodation requests, please reach out to us at info@akronmarathon.org.



FINISH LINE

Finish Line Location

The Finish Line is located on S. Main St just outside Lock 3.

Participants will receive water, their medal and their series medal, for race series finishers, after crossing the finish line. Marathon and Half Marathon participants will be given a Heatsheet to keep warm. If you are in need of medical attention there will be a medical tent available on S. Main St.

Family Reunion

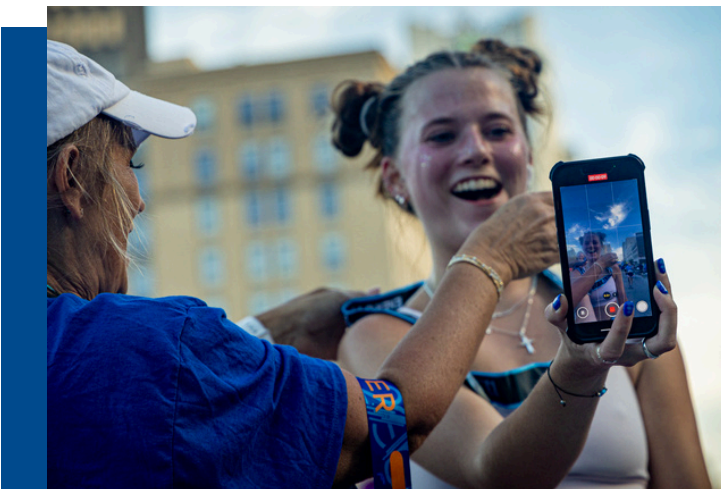
It is encouraged to designate a reunion location and meeting time (i.e. 30 minutes after your anticipated finish time) prior to starting your race.

Lost and Found

Lost items will be taken to the Information Booth located inside the Finisher Festival. Items left at the race will be taken to the Akron Marathon office and kept for 2 weeks.

Shower Facilities

Showers and changing facilities will be available, free of charge, courtesy of the Downtown YMCA located at 477 E. Market St (1.5 miles from Lock 3). Please bring your bib and photo ID for access.



Results and Awards

For final results and live updates visit AkronMarathon.org/results.

Prize Money

Marathon				
	Open Men	Open Women	Masters Men	Masters Women
1st Place	\$2,000	\$2,000	\$500	\$500
2nd Place	\$1,250	\$1,250	\$350	\$350
3rd Place	\$800	\$800	\$250	\$250

Ohio Resident		
This prize money is awarded to the first male and female to finish the marathon who are residents of the state of Ohio at the time of the race regardless of age.		
	Open Men	Open Women
1st Place	\$500	\$500

Half Marathon				
	Open Men	Open Women	Masters Men	Masters Women
1st Place	\$1,000	\$1,000	\$300	\$300
2nd Place	\$600	\$600	\$250	\$250
3rd Place	\$400	\$400	\$200	\$200

Event Record Incentives				
	Open Men	Open Women	Masters Men	Masters Women
Full Marathon	\$500 [2:15:59]	\$500 [2:39:09]	\$500 [2:23:44]	\$500 [2:49:52]
Half Marathon	\$500 [1:03:58]	\$500 [1:14:18]	\$500 [1:05:16]	\$500 [1:23:02]

Overall Awards

An award ceremony will take place at 8:50 a.m. for the Half Marathon and 10:45 a.m. for the Full Marathon.

Age Group Awards

Top three Male and Female Marathon and Half Marathon finishers in all age categories will receive awards: 19 and under, 20-24, 25-29, 30-34, 35-39, 40-44, 45-49, 50-54, 55-59, 60-64, 65-69, 70-74, 74-79, and 80+. You can win only one award. Overall and masters winners are taken out of age group awards.

Team Relay Awards

Top three teams in the Men's, Women's, Mixed, Masters Men's, Masters Women's, and Masters Mixed categories of the 5-Person Team Relay will receive awards.

Non-Binary Awards

Top three overall finishers in the Marathon and Half Marathon will receive an award. These awards are based on chip time.

Wheelchair Division Awards

Top finishers in each division will receive an award. These awards are based on gun time.

Age Group, Team Relay, Non-Binary, and wheelchair awards will be mailed 6-8 weeks after the race.

FINISHER FESTIVAL



As you enter the FirstEnergy Finisher Festival at Lock 3, there will be an Information Booth, medal engraving, merchandise tent and indoor restrooms. Celebrate your accomplishment by enjoying the live band on the Maynard Performance Pavilion and redeem food and drink tickets. Families can visit the PNC Mobile Learning Adventure as well.

For medal engraving visit AkronMarathon.org/results to view your finish time. Ritchie's Sporting Goods is providing the service for a \$15 fee. You may pre-register, through 9/20, and pay for the service during registration or pay onsite.

Official Akron Marathon merchandise is available for purchase at the Fleet Feet booth in the Finisher Festival.

Participants in multiple legs or events can pick up their relay and series medal at the information booth.

Please be aware. Unopened or opened beer cannot be taken outside of the Finisher Festival area.

Sustainable Waste Stations

Please help support our sustainability efforts by placing all trash and recycling items on a table at any of our Waste Stations in the Finisher Festival. Green team volunteers will assist in diversion of each item to the correct bin. Your efforts help us strive towards keeping this a Zero Waste event!

Tickets On Your Bib

Each participant will receive the following tickets attached to their bib:

- One drink ticket - can be redeemed for your choice of two drinks- beer or soda.
- One food truck ticket - can be redeemed for one item from any food truck.
- One food bag ticket - can be redeemed for one Acme food bag.

Acme Food Bag & Finisher Fluids

Redeem your food bag ticket inside the Lock 3 Commons to receive your Acme Food Bag that includes a banana, pretzels, and more! Visit the fluid tent next to the food trucks to get your post-race chocolate milk, Gatorade, and an extra bottle of water.



Food Trucks at the Finish

Each participant's food truck ticket can be redeemed for one item off the list below.

Chick-fil-A

- Original Chick-fil-A chicken sandwich

City Barbeque

- Chicken topped Mac & Cheese
- Pork topped Mac & Cheese
- Coleslaw topped Black Bean Burger (vegan & gluten free)

Sandy Bottom Bowls

- The Original (6oz): smoothie base (açai, banana, strawberry, apple juice) topped with granola, banana, drizzle of Ohio Honey (Gluten-free/vegan options available upon request)

Swensons

- Double Cheeseburg
- Double Hamburg
- Galley Boy: A Swensons favorite! Our signature double cheeseburg with two special sauces, Swen RED & Swen WHITE



Achieve a Personal Record? Ring the PR Bell in the Finisher Festival to celebrate!



TEAM RELAY

Transportation

The provided shuttle service is highly encouraged as driving and parking are extremely limited and restricted in some areas. Relay legs 1, 2 & 3 will walk to the start of their legs in downtown. Relay legs 4 & 5 should park downtown and take the shuttle to the start of their relay leg.

Shuttle Times:

Leg 4 - Downtown to Sand Run:
7:15 a.m.-10:15 a.m.

Leg 5 - Downtown to Firestone CLC:
7:30 a.m.-11:15 a.m.

For additional information, visit the Akron Marathon website and read the Team Relay Guide.

Arriving

Once you arrive at your Relay Exchange Zone take time to familiarize yourself with the corrals, visit the restrooms, and prepare for your leg of the relay. When your team member is approximately 10 minutes from the exchange zone please proceed to the numerical staging area, based on your bib number. Spotters will be calling out the last three numbers on your bib as your teammate approaches the exchange zone. PLEASE KNOW YOUR BIB NUMBER. Once your bib number is called please move to the front row of your corral to meet your teammate and start your leg of the relay. There will be bottled water available for participants starting at the exchange zone and for all participants finishing at each exchange zone.

Relay Exchange Zone Procedures

As you finish your leg of the relay, you will be directed to cross over a timing mat. Continue for a short distance beyond the timing mat where race volunteers will assist you in finding your teammate. Upon finding your teammate, clear the racecourse. Finishing participants will receive their medal at the Relay Exchange Zone and can head to the FirstEnergy Finisher Festival at Lock 3. Relay leg 5 will finish on Main St and receive their medal before entering the Finisher Festival.

ARRIVAL TIMES TO RELAY LEG

(30 MINUTES BEFORE ANTICIPATED FINISH OF PRIOR LEG)

LEG	DISTANCE	START LOCATION	7 MIN PACE	9 MIN PACE	11 MIN PACE	13 MIN PACE	15 MIN PACE
#1	7.2	1 S. High St Start Line	6:30 am	6:30 am	6:30 am	6:30 am	6:30 am
#2	5.5	245 Wolf Ledges Pkwy Mile 7.2	7:20 am	7:35 am	7:50 am	8:05 am	8:20 am
#3	4.6	30 N. Main St Mile 12.7	8:00 am	8:25 am	8:50 am	9:15 am	9:45 am
#4	4.4	1300 Sand Run Pkwy Mile 17.3	8:30 am*	9:00 am*	9:45 am*	10:15 am*	10:45 am*
#5	4.5	1565 Fairfax Rd Mile 21.7	9:00 am*	9:45 am*	10:30 am*	11:10 am*	11:45 am*

Shuttle
Location

Located on
Main St. at
State St.

***RECOMMENDED TO BOARD RELAY BUS 30 MINUTES PRIOR TO
ARRIVAL TIME FOR RELAY LEGS 4 & 5**



2026 Marathon Course

AKRON
MARATHON
RACE SERIES

PRESENTED BY

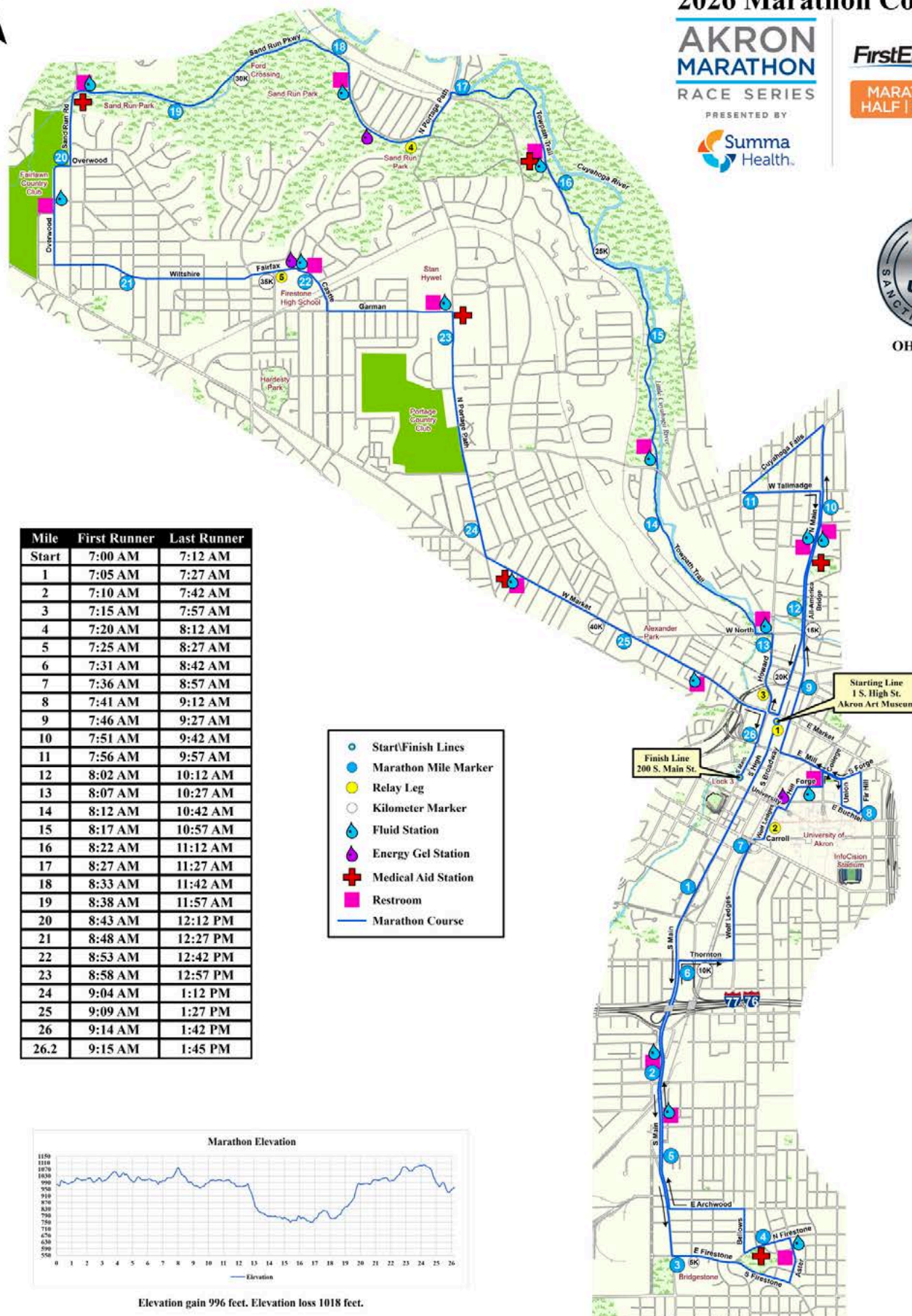


FirstEnergy

**MARATHON
HALF | RELAY**



OH25038JHP



Mile	First Runner	Last Runner
Start	7:00 AM	7:12 AM
1	7:05 AM	7:27 AM
2	7:10 AM	7:42 AM
3	7:15 AM	7:57 AM
4	7:20 AM	8:12 AM
5	7:25 AM	8:27 AM
6	7:31 AM	8:42 AM
7	7:36 AM	8:57 AM
8	7:41 AM	9:12 AM
9	7:46 AM	9:27 AM
10	7:51 AM	9:42 AM
11	7:56 AM	9:57 AM
12	8:02 AM	10:12 AM
13	8:07 AM	10:27 AM
14	8:12 AM	10:42 AM
15	8:17 AM	10:57 AM
16	8:22 AM	11:12 AM
17	8:27 AM	11:27 AM
18	8:33 AM	11:42 AM
19	8:38 AM	11:57 AM
20	8:43 AM	12:12 PM
21	8:48 AM	12:27 PM
22	8:53 AM	12:42 PM
23	8:58 AM	12:57 PM
24	9:04 AM	1:12 PM
25	9:09 AM	1:27 PM
26	9:14 AM	1:42 PM
26.2	9:15 AM	1:45 PM



Elevation gain 996 feet. Elevation loss 1018 feet.



2026 Half Marathon Course

**AKRON
MARATHON**
RACE SERIES

PRESENTED BY



FirstEnergy

**MARATHON
HALF | RELAY**



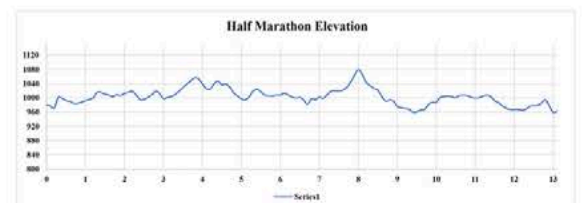
OH25036JHP



Mile	First Runner	Last Runner
Start	7:00 AM	7:12 AM
1	7:04 AM	7:28 AM
2	7:09 AM	7:44 AM
3	7:14 AM	8:00 AM
4	7:19 AM	8:16 AM
5	7:24 AM	8:32 AM
6	7:29 AM	8:48 AM
7	7:34 AM	9:04 AM
8	7:39 AM	9:20 AM
9	7:44 AM	9:36 AM
10	7:49 AM	9:52 AM
11	7:54 AM	10:08 AM
12	7:59 AM	10:24 AM
13	8:04 AM	10:40 AM
13.1	8:05 AM	10:42 AM



- Start/Finish Lines
- Half Mile Marker
- Relay Leg
- Kilometer Marker
- Fluid Station
- Energy Gel Station
- Medical Aid Station
- Restroom
- Half Marathon Course



Elevation gain 406 feet. Elevation loss 419 feet.

2026 START LINE MAP

AKRON MARATHON
RACE SERIES

PRESENTED BY



FirstEnergy

MARATHON
HALF | RELAY

Start of
Relay Leg #3

Restrooms
(60)

Akron Public
Schools

W MARKET ST

Restrooms

Corrals

01234
AKRON MARATHON

Wave 2

Wave 3 & 4

Wave 5, 6 & 7

Restrooms
(8)

Restrooms
(5)

Restrooms
(12)

Wave 1

Start

Volunteer
Check In

VIP
Elite

Restricted
Area

Library

John S. Knight
Center

VIP
Parking

Parking
Lot

E MARKET ST

S SUMMIT ST

BROADWAY ST

S HIGH ST

S MAIN ST

MILL ST

High Street closed
at Mill Street.
Road will open at 6:50am
for start of race
and spectator viewing.

Spectator Viewing
Area

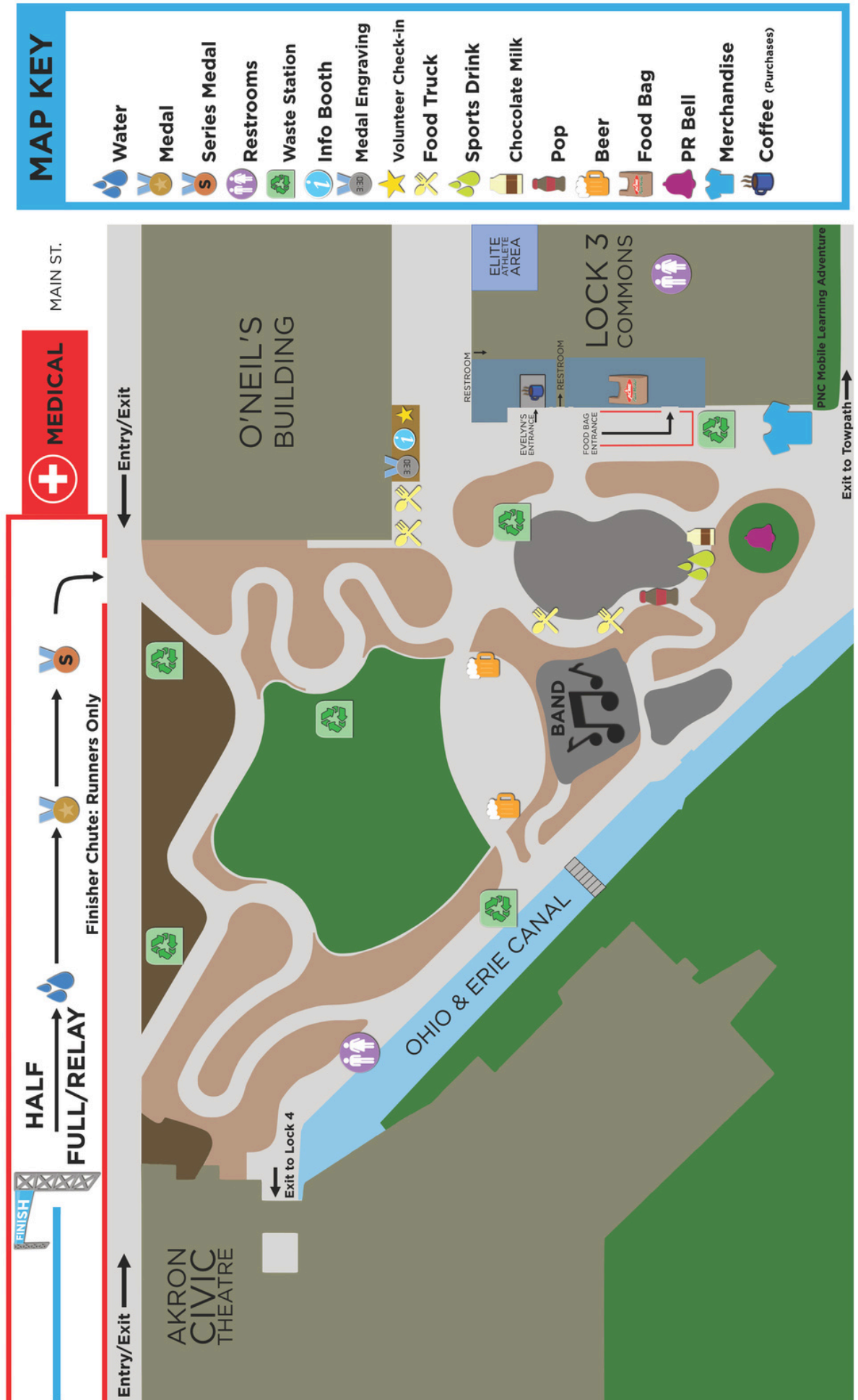
Greystone
Hall

E MILL ST

- Water
- Medical
- Information Tent
- Restroom
- VIP
- Restricted Area
- Routes to restrooms and corrals
- Access to corrals. Bib required past this point.

2026 Finish Line Map

FirstEnergy® Finisher Festival at **Lock 3** AKRON



Kids Fun Run Course

AKRON MARATHON RACE SERIES

PRESENTED BY



The Mandel Family



PRESENTED BY



Friday, September 25, 2026
6:00 pm

5:00pm - Bib Pickup Opens
6:00pm - Race Start
7:30pm - Event Ends

* Kids Fun Run Course is just under 1 mile



*Map Created By Wendy Doyle - GIS Cartographer

Created By: X:\Users\Wendy\Akron_Marathon\2026\September ArcGIS Pro\Akron_Marathon_September_Races\Akron_Marathon_September_Races.aprx 5/21/2026

ROAD CLOSURES

Friday, September 25, 2026

Road Closure	Restrictions	Approximate Time
S. Main St.	Between Bowery St. and State St.	Beginning at 8:00 a.m.
W. Bowery St.	Between W. State St. and W. Exchange St.	2:30 p.m. - 7:00 p.m.
Rt. 59 East	I-76 East to N. Main St.	5:30 p.m. - 7:00 p.m.
S. High St.	Between MLK Blvd. and E. Mill St.	Beginning at 6:30 p.m.

Saturday, September 26, 2026

Road Closure	Restrictions	Approximate Time
S. Main St.	Between State St. and Exchange St.	6:00 a.m. - 2:00 p.m.
E. Buchtel Ave.	Between Maiden Ln and S. Main St.	6:00 a.m. - 2:00 p.m.
E. Market St.	Between S. Main St. and Broadway St.	4:00 a.m. - 10:30 a.m.
E. Mill St.	Between S. Main St. and Broadway St.	4:00 a.m. - 10:35 a.m.
S. High St.	Between Mill St. and E. Bowery St.	4:00 a.m. - 7:30 a.m.
S. High St.	Between E. Bowery St. and E. Thornton St.	6:50 a.m. - 7:30 a.m.
S. Main St. under S. High St. Bridge	Between Rosa Parks Dr. and E. Thornton St.	6:50 a.m. - 7:30 a.m.
S. Main St. (Southbound)	Between E. Thornton St. and E. Wilbeth Rd.	6:50 a.m. - 8:10 a.m.
S. Main St. (Northbound)	Between E. Thornton St. and E. Wilbeth Rd.	6:50 a.m. - 8:50 a.m.
E. Firestone Blvd.	Between S. Main St. and S. Firestone Blvd.	7:05 a.m. - 8:10 a.m.
S. Firestone Blvd.	Between E. Firestone Ave. and Aster Ave.	7:05 a.m. - 8:10 a.m.
Aster Ave.	Between N. Firestone Blvd. and S. Firestone Blvd.	7:05 a.m. - 8:15 a.m.
N. Firestone Blvd.	Between E. Firestone Blvd. and Aster Ave.	7:10 a.m. - 8:20 a.m.
Bellows St.	Between N. Firestone Blvd. and Archwood Ave.	7:15 a.m. - 8:20 a.m.
Archwood Ave.	Between Bellows St. and S. Main St.	7:15 a.m. - 8:30 a.m.
E. Thornton St.	Between S. Main St. and Wolf Ledges Pkwy	7:15 a.m. - 9:00 a.m.
Wolf Ledges Pkwy	Between Carroll St. and University Ave.	6:45 a.m. - 9:30 a.m.
Wolf Ledges Pkwy	Between E. Thornton St. and University Ave.	7:25 a.m. - 9:10 a.m.
University Ave.	Between Broadway and Hill St.	7:25 a.m. - 9:10 a.m.
Hill St.	Between S. Forge St. and University Ave.	7:25 a.m. - 9:15 a.m.
S. Forge St.	Between Hill St. and S. College St.	7:25 a.m. - 9:15 a.m.
S. College St.	Between E. Market St. and Buchtel Ave.	7:25 a.m. - 9:20 a.m.
E. Mill St.	Between Fir Hill and S. Broadway St.	7:25 a.m. - 9:30 a.m.
S. Union St.	Between E. Mill St and Buchtel Ave.	7:25 a.m. - 9:20 a.m.
E. Buchtel Ave.	Between Spicer St. and Hill St.	7:25 a.m. - 9:20 a.m.
Fir Hill	Between S. Forge St. and E. Buchtel Ave.	7:30 a.m. - 9:25 a.m.
Broadway St.	Between MLK Blvd. (Route 59) and Exchange St.	7:30 a.m. - 10:35 a.m.
Market St.	Between Rand Ave. and Forge St.	7:30 a.m. - 10:35 a.m.
All American Bridge (Northbound)	Between N. Main St. and MLK Blvd. (Route 59)	7:35 a.m. - 10:00 a.m.
N. Main St. (Northbound)	Between E. Cuyahoga Falls Ave. and Olive St.	7:35 a.m. - 10:00 a.m.
E. Cuyahoga Falls Ave.	Between N. Main St. and Carpenter St.	7:40 a.m. - 10:05 a.m.
Tallmadge Ave.	Between Cuyahoga St. and N. Main St.	7:40 a.m. - 10:15 a.m.
N. Main St. (Southbound)	Between E. Cuyahoga Falls Ave. and Olive St.	7:40 a.m. - 10:20 a.m.
All American Bridge (Southbound)	Between MLK Blvd. (Route 59) and N. Main St.	7:30 a.m. - 10:30 a.m.
Martin Luther King BLVD (Route 59)	Between Broadway and West Center St.	7:30 a.m. - 10:30 a.m.
N. Main St.	Between Market St. and MLK Blvd. (Route 59)	7:10 a.m. - 11:00 a.m.
N. Howard St. (Southbound)	Between N. Main St. and Cuyahoga St.	7:55 a.m. - 10:30 a.m.
W. North St.	Between N. Howard St. and N. Maple St.	7:55 a.m. - 10:30 a.m.
Merriman Rd.	Between Treaty Line and N. Portage Path	8:15 a.m. - 11:30 a.m.
N. Portage Path	Between Treaty Line and Merriman Rd.	8:15 a.m. - 11:30 a.m.
Sand Run Pkwy	Between N. Portage Path and Revere Rd.	12:00 p.m. (Fri) - 12:00 p.m.
Sand Run Rd.	Between W. Market St. and Smith Rd.	8:30 a.m. - 12:10 p.m.
Overwood Rd.	Between Sand Run Rd. and Wiltshire Rd.	8:30 a.m. - 12:20 p.m.
Wiltshire Rd.	Between Overwood Rd. and N. Hawkins Ave.	8:30 a.m. - 12:35 p.m.
Fairfax Rd.	Between Rampart Ave. and Castle Blvd.	8:00 a.m. - 1:00 p.m.
Fairfax Rd.	Between N. Hawkins Ave. and Castle Blvd.	8:30 a.m. - 12:45 p.m.
Rampart Ave.	Between Fairfax Rd. and Bond St.	8:30 a.m. - 12:45 p.m.
Castle Blvd.	Between Fairfax Rd. and Garman Rd.	8:40 a.m. - 12:45 p.m.
Garman Rd.	Between Melbourne Ave. and N. Portage Path	8:40 a.m. - 12:55 p.m.
N. Portage Path (Southbound)	Between Mayfair Rd. and W. Market St.	8:50 a.m. - 1:15 p.m.
W. Market St. (Eastbound)	Between Portage Path and S. Main St.	8:55 a.m. - 1:40 p.m.
S. Main St.	Between Market St. and W. Bowery St.	7:50 a.m. - 1:45 a.m.
IR 76 W / Exit 22 (Downtown)	Detour to Route 59	6:50 a.m. - 9:00 a.m.
IR 76 E / Exit 22 (Downtown)	Detour to South St. / Exit 21B	6:50 a.m. - 8:10 a.m.

On race day use the WAZE app for directions around road closures.

Directions and Parking

Please note that we are expecting 7,000 participants as well as thousands of volunteers and spectators making their way to downtown Akron on race morning. It is recommended to be downtown before 6:00 a.m.

The routes below offer minimal road closing interference and include directional signage to suggested parking based on race day arrival times.

Additional signage will be placed downtown to direct foot traffic to the Start Line, Finish Line, relay legs 2 & 3, and relay shuttle buses.

If you are a relay member coming into town after 6:50 a.m., roads will start to close along the course route. Please plan accordingly and park in the recommended decks and lots. Also, keep in mind that certain lots and decks will have delayed exiting.

Arriving before 7:00 a.m.

Decks along High St, Broadway, and Exchange St are suggested for participants planning to race/watch the start. Decks along the course close at 7:00 a.m.

From the north or west Via I-77 (Cleveland/Fairlawn):
I-77/I-76 (they run concurrently) to Main/Downtown/Univ of Akron. Stay to the left after you exit and make a left turn at the first light onto Main St. Main St. becomes Broadway.

From the east Via I-76:
I-76/I-77 (they run concurrently). Exit at Main/Broadway/Downtown. Continue onto Broadway.

From the south Via I-71:
I-71 to I-76 east, continue onto 224 east to I-77 north and continue on Rt 8 north. From there follow options 1 & 2 below.

From the south Via I-77 & east Via I-76:
I-77/I-76 to Rt 8 north.

Option 1: To High/Broadway decks: Exit at Perkins. Turn left on Perkins, turn left on Main St. Left on Bowery St. Right on High St.

Option 2: To Buchtel/Exchange St decks: Exit at OH-18/Carroll St/Buchtel Ave (Exit 1A). Continue onto Fountain St. Turn left on Carroll St. Route differs from here based on which deck you choose.

Important Addresses

Please note, once you get into downtown, road closings may detour you.

- Start Line/ Akron Art Museum:
1 S. High St, Akron
- Relay Leg #2:
245 Wolf Ledges Pkwy, Akron
- Relay Leg #3:
30 N. Main St, Akron
- Shuttle Buses:
300 S. Main St, Akron
- Finish Line:
200 S. Main St, Akron

From the north Via I-77 (Cleveland): I-80 to Rt 8. Follow Rt 8 south.

Option 1: Take Perkins St exit (1B). Turn right on Perkins St; turn left on Main St.

Option 2: Take Goodkirk St. exit (1A). Turn right on Buchtel Ave or Exchange St.

Arriving after 7:00 a.m.

Decks and lots on the west side of Main St and on Exchange St are suggested for relay legs 2-5 arriving after 7:00 a.m. Please note roads along the course will close at 7:00 a.m.

From the south Via I-77:
Exit to continue on I-77 north/ I-76 west. From there follow directions below.

From the east taking I-77/I-76 west:
I-77/I-76 (they run concurrently) Take Exit 21C for 59/Dart Ave. Turn right after you exit onto Boulevard St. Stay left to continue on Dart Ave. Route differs from here based on which deck you choose.

From the south taking I-71 to I-76 east:
Follow 76 east into downtown Akron. From there follow directions below.

From the north or west Via I-77:
(Cleveland/ Fairlawn):
Take Exit 21C onto OH-59 east/Downtown. Take exit for Cedar St/Exchange St and merge onto Dart. Route differs from here based on which deck you choose.

Downtown Akron Locations - 2026

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Relay Shuttle Schedule

To Relay Leg 4: 7:15 a.m. until 10:15 a.m.

To Relay Leg 5: 7:30 a.m. until 11:15 a.m.

XXXX Road Closures - Friday

Main from Bowery to State (beginning at 8:00am)
High from Mill to MLK (beginning 6:30pm)
Bowery from Exchange to State (2:30pm – 7:00pm)

— Road Closures - Saturday Morning

Market from Main to Broadway (beginning at 4:00am)
Mill from Broadway to Main (beginning at 4:00am)
High from Mill to Bowery (beginning at 4:00am)
Main from Exchange to State (beginning 6:00am)
Buchtel From Maiden Lane to Main (beginning at 6:00am)

— Road Closures - Saturday Morning 6:50am

* For complete list of road closures visit AkronMarathon.org

#	Address	Parking Instructions
D4	40 S. High St.	Friday only until 5:00pm - No parking on race day
D2	10 W. Mill St.	No Restrictions
D6	51 W. State St.	No Restrictions
D7	666 S. Broadway St.	No Restrictions
D8	11 W. Mill St.	No Restrictions
D10	199 W. Bowery St.	No Restrictions
L1	500 S. Main St.	No Restrictions
L36	261 E. Exchange St.	No Restrictions
D1	120 S. Broadway St.	Delayed exit 7:30am
D3	132 S. High St.	Delayed exit 7:30am
D9	200 S. High St.	Delayed exit 7:30am
L49	275 S. High St.	Delayed exit 7:30am
L26	255 E. Buchtel Ave.	Delayed exit 9:30am
L28	198 Hill St.	Delayed exit 9:30am

- Start/Finish Lines
- Points of Interest
- Relay Leg
- ♿ Handicap Parking
- Suggested Parking for Packet Pickup
- ▨ Relay Shuttle Pick Up/Drop Off
- ▨ Hotel Shuttle Bus Pick Up/Drop Off
- XXXX Road Closures - Friday
- Road Closures - Saturday Morning 6:50am
- Road Closures - Saturday Morning
- Marathon Course
- Half Marathon Course

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- The Read Family Fund
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- VanDevere Automotive Group

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Registration
for all 2027
events opens
in October.